

source offering. Besides, WalmartLabs plans to move SamsClub.com and Walmart Grocery to the scalable solution in the near future.

"Among server-side rendered pages, the home page is now 20 per cent faster and the login page is 15 per cent faster. The checkout page, which is client-side rendered, is 20 per cent faster. Pages that were client-side rendered and are now server-side rendered have seen performance improvements of up to 30 per cent. Furthermore, our JavaScript bundle size has decreased by 20 per cent," Grigoryan said.

FUEL project aims to develop language resources using open source efforts

Alongside tech enthusiasts in a packed hall at a five-star hotel in New Delhi, organisations like C-DAC GIST, Red Hat, Mozilla, The Document Foundation and CSDS-Sarai came together for several rounds of discussions on localisation through the open source way, at the FUEL GILT conference, 2016.

The FUEL project organised the two-day conference with the help of different organisations. This open source project, started by Rajesh Ranjan in 2008, empowers technology enablers with linguistic and technical resources and offers a reference standard for various localisation practices.

"FUEL is one of the rare projects that emanated from India, and is now associated with various language communities and organisations across the world," 43-year-old Ranjan said.

Apart from its presence in applications being developed by various private organisations, FUEL is powering several e-governance projects of the Indian government.

At the conference, Vinay Thakur, director (projects) at the National



e-Governance Division, Ministry of Electronics and Information Technology (MeitY), stressed on the importance of localisation in major government projects. Thakur, who has

more than two decades of experience in launching various IT and e-governance projects, revealed that the government is set to bring local language support to feature phones. The government is additionally working on a unified mobile app experience with a localised experience, he stated.

Thakur told the attendees that over 100 government websites are already featuring local languages to reach the masses across the country. There are also plans to convert an existing 630 million land records to local languages, he added.

Mahesh Kulkarni, associate director of C-DAC and head of GIST Research Labs, joined the conference as one of the panellists. He showcased the introduction of localisation in the National e-Governance Plan. Kulkarni also highlighted the availability of the open source GO Translate plugin that enables Web-based applications to offer language options and localisation in over 12 Indian languages.

The conference was attended by the volunteers of the Wikimedia Foundation who are translating Wikipedia content into various Indian languages. Also, Mozilla hosted a hackathon on the sidelines of the conference to nurture job-oriented skills among Indian developers.

"It is great to see that a project I started eight years back is now supported

Azure App Service gets native Linux support for Node.js and PHP stacks

Underscoring its interest for the open source community, Microsoft has now upgraded its Azure App Service with native Linux support for Node.js and PHP stacks. The Platform-as-a-Service (PaaS) was initially limited to .NET developers.

Launched in March 2015, Microsoft's Azure App Service has so far attracted more than 350,000 active customers that have together hosted over a million Web and mobile applications. Though these numbers appear to be enough for the platform, the Redmond company has planned to attract developers with the native Linux support. This will primarily overcome issues with operating system compatibility.

"While PHP and Node.js have also been supported in App Service since the launch, we have heard loud and clear from some developers that having to deal with operating system compatibility quirks, like 'path too long' errors with npm or the web.config files and page rendering pipelines, is too cumbersome," wrote Nazim Lala, software engineer for Azure App Service, in a blog post.

The preview version allows developers to choose Linux as an alternative to Windows and run Web applications right on the open source ecosystem. Moreover, the platform offers streamlined abilities with deployment slots, custom domains, SSL configuration, continuous deployment, as well as horizontal and vertical scaling.

The Azure team has updated the marketplace instance of WordPress to run the CMS on Apache or Linux. Also, there are plans to bring out similar updates for Drupal and Joomla shortly.